



AI SEO Mastery Pro [Start ...

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Getting Started



SEO Foundation



Setting Up Your AI



Local SEO Foundations



How to Do Local AI SEO



The Google Business Pr...



Creating AI Content



Building a Core 30 Web...



Starting Off-Site AI SEO



Optimizing for AI Syste...



Special Circumstances



YMYL-Niche Sites

Ethics: E-E-A-T Authorship ...

When to Use a Sitemap

NoFollow Attributes on Links

Hiding Content from Users

Disavowing Existing Backlin...

Non-Local SEO



Ethics: E-E-A-T Authorship Method



1.2x

3-min ⚡ 2 min 30 sec

In this lesson, we'll explore a controversial shortcut some websites use to establish E-E-A-T (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trustworthiness) with Google. While we don't recommend this approach due to ethical concerns, it's important you understand these tactics to recognize them in the competitive landscape.

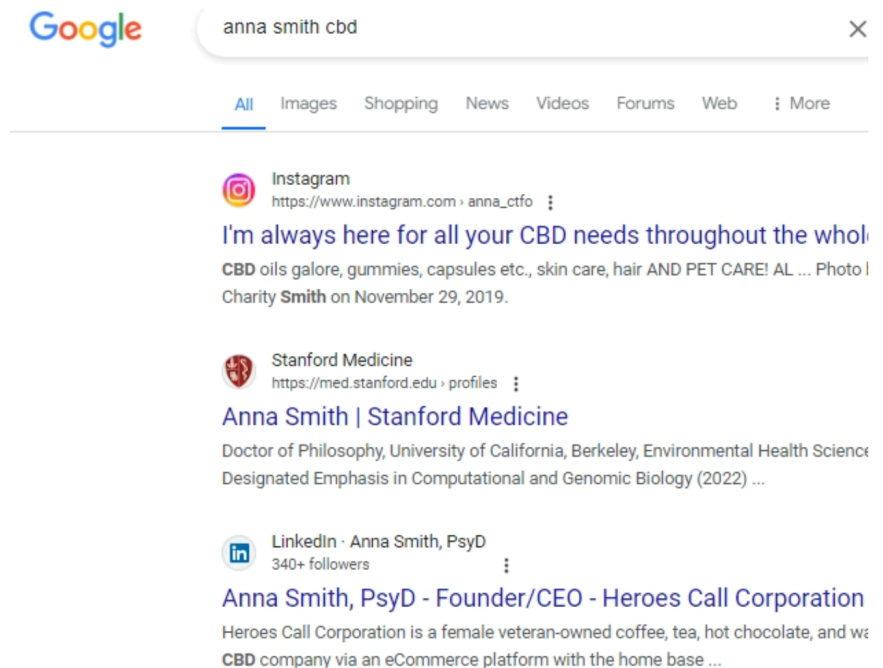
Many website owners face a common dilemma when it comes to establishing E-E-A-T:

- They may not want their real name publicly associated with their website
- Building genuine author authority takes significant time and effort
- Competition may be using shortcuts that seem to provide quick wins

Recent insights from Google API leaks suggest that when an author name appears on a website, Google stores attributes about that author based on what it has observed across the entire internet. This discovery has led to some questionable practices in the SEO community.



Websites create fictional authors using extremely common names (like "Anna Smith") that already have established authority in their industry. They pair these names with AI-generated photos and attempt to "borrow" the collective authority Google associates with all the real people sharing that name in the space.



Real-World Example: The CBD Industry Case

During competitive analysis for a client in the CBD space, we discovered a competitor using this exact tactic:

- **The Setup:** A competitor with a much lower domain rating was significantly outranking our client
- **The Discovery:** Their content byline showed "Anna Smith" with an AI-generated photo
- **The Pattern:** Multiple real Anna Smiths exist in the CBD space, including:
 - Medical professionals at Stanford Medicine discussing CBD
 - CEOs of CBD companies



The competitor had created a new "Anna Smith" that didn't match any of these real people but potentially benefited from the collective authority Google associates with that name in the CBD space.

💡 **Note:** This tactic used to be more effective with just AI-generated images and generic names. Google's algorithms have become more sophisticated, but some sites still attempt variations of this approach.

Why This Matters for Your SEO Strategy

While this tactic might provide short-term gains for your competitors, it carries significant risks, including potential Google penalties if detected or reported. Damage to brand reputation if exposed, and legal implications of misrepresentation. There are also significant ethical concerns about deceiving users. Learning about tactics is useful if you are trying to rank in more controversial and competitive spaces such as CBD, so you can:

1. **Recognize Competitor Strategies:** If you see competitors ranking well with generic author names and AI photos, they may be using this shortcut
2. **Make Informed Decisions:** Know what tactics are available while understanding their risks
3. **Maintain Ethical Standards:** Choose ethical strategies that align with your values and long-term business goals

💡 **Remember:** Google's algorithms continue to evolve, and what works as a shortcut today may become a penalty tomorrow. Focus on strategies that will stand the test of time and algorithm updates.

The Better Alternative: Building Genuine E-E-A-T



Instead, focus on legitimate E-E-A-T building strategies covered in our lesson "[What is E-E-A-T?](#)":

- Create detailed, genuine author profiles
- Build real expertise through quality content
- Establish verifiable credentials
- Develop authentic industry connections
- Contribute to reputable publications in your field